BY ORDER OF THE SECRETARY OF THE AIR FORCE

HEADQUARTERS AIR FORCE MISSION DIRECTIVE 1-52

11 SEPTEMBER 2026

DIRECTOR OF TEST AND EVALUATION

COMPLIANCE WITH THIS PUBLICATION IS MANDATORY

ACCESSIBILITY: Publications and forms are available on the e-Publishing website at **www.e-publishing.af.mil**

RELEASABILITY: There are no releasability restrictions on this publication

---

OPR: AF/TEP

Certified by: AF/TE
(Mr. Christopher Wilcox)

Supersedes: HAFMD 1-52, 20 April 2021

Pages: 10

---

1. Mission . The Director of Test and Evaluation (AF/TE), pursuant to Title 10 United States Code Section (U.S.C. §) 9032, and as documented by paragraph(s) A2.3.11 of Headquarters Department of the Air Force Mission Directive (HQDAFMD) 1-1, *Headquarters Department of the Air Force (HQ DAF)*, and this Headquarters Air Force Mission Directive (HAFMD), assists the Office of the Secretary of the Air Force, Secretariat Principal Officials, the Chief of Staff (CSAF), and the Chief of Space Operations (CSO) in carrying out the test and evaluation (T&E) programs of the Department of the Air Force. The Secretary of the Air Force (SecAF) retains ultimate responsibility for all DAF policies. Within their areas of responsibility, the AF/TE prepares detailed instructions for the execution of approved plans, supervises the execution of those plans and instructions, prepares policies for approval and issues guidance/procedures, via official DAF level publications, to ensure implementation of those policies. The AF/TE also assists the CSAF and CSO in their roles, pursuant to 10 USC § 151, as members of the Joint Chiefs of Staff (JCS).

2. Organizational Relationships. Subject only to the authority, direction, and control of the Secretary of Defense (referred to as the Secretary of War), the SecAF is responsible for, and has all legal authority necessary to conduct, the affairs of the DAF. The Secretariat, Air Staff, and the Office of the Chief of Space Operations (known as the Space Staff) offices perform their DAF functions subject to the authority, direction, and control of the SecAF.

2.1. The AF/TE furnishes professional assistance to the SecAF, the Under Secretary of the Air Force (USecAF), other Secretariat officials, the CSAF, the CSO, and their respective staff offices. AF/TE reports directly to the Vice Chief of Staff of the Air Force (VCSAF), while answerable to the Vice Chief of Space Operations (VCSO) on all Space T&E matters. The SecAF may re-delegate authority/assign responsibility to AF/TE, but the SecAF, through the CSAF and, as appropriate, Assistant Secretaries of the Air Force, retains ultimate responsibility for all matters listed in **Attachment 1** of this publication.

2.2. The AF/TE is a part of the Air Staff and as such works closely with other DAF offices to assist the SecAF, the CSAF, and the CSO in carrying out their responsibilities. The AF/TE and the Office of the AF/TE work in close cooperation with the VCSAF, VCSO, Assistant Secretaries of the Air Force, Air and Space Staff Principal Officials, and their respective offices, who are responsible, pursuant to Chapters **903**, **905**, and **908** of Title 10 (10 U.S.C. §§ 9013-9025, §§ 9031-9040, and §§ 9081-9087), for assisting the SecAF, CSAF, and CSO in carrying out their responsibilities.

3. Responsibilities. The AF/TE:

3.1. Serves as the chief T&E advisor to the SecAF, USecAF, CSAF, CSO, VCSAF, VCSO, and their respective staffs.

3.2. Develops T&E policy for SecAF approval, establishes test guidance, advocates for test resources to support weapons system development, prototyping, and experimentation activities. Resolves Developmental Test and Evaluation (DT&E) and Operational Test and Evaluation (OT&E) programmatic issues.

3.3. Provides guidance, direction, and oversight for all matters pertaining to the formulation, review, and execution of T&E plans, policies, programs, reports and budgets. Acts as the final DAF review authority and signatory for T&E master plans or other test strategy documentation prior to Air Force or Space Force Service Acquisition Executive approval and signature. Reviews and/or prepares the release of T&E reports outside the DAF and ensures test results are available to decision makers in a timely manner.

3.4. Manages the test infrastructure for the DAF to ensure adequate T&E facilities, resources, and expertise are available to support system life cycle T&E activities. Provides strategic oversight and advocates facility security and protection of the T&E infrastructure.

3.5. Acts as the lead and point of contact for the DAF Foreign Materiel Program (FMP). Co-chairs the FMP Committee with the Deputy Chief of Staff of the Air Force for Intelligence (AF/A2) and the Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Intelligence (SF/S2). Serves as a member of the Joint FMP Office Board. Represents the DAF on the Department of War (DoW) FMP Executive Committee and FMP Board of Directors.

3.6. Coordinates with multiple staffs external to the DAF including: The Director, Operational Test and Evaluation (DOT&E) within the Office of the Secretary of War; Executive Director, Developmental Test, Evaluation and Assessments (D(DTE&A) within the Office of the Under Secretary of War for Research and Engineering OUSW(R&E); the Director, Test Resources Management Center (TRMC); other United States armed services, War Organizations, and agencies.

3.7. Serves as the DAF Functional Manager for acquisition T&E personnel under the Acquisition Professional Development Program. Provides strategic oversight and force development advocacy related to T&E occupational requirements as the DAF Test Enterprise Cross-Functional Authority. Identifies cross-functional billets and associated proficiency levels and training/experience development needed to successfully conduct the T&E mission.

4. Delegations of Secretary of the Air Force Authority and Assignments of Responsibility. **Attachment 1** lists authorities delegated and responsibilities assigned by SecAF to AF/TE. The authorities delegated/responsibilities assigned to AF/TE by this directive may be re-delegated or reassigned to a subordinate official unless re-delegation is expressly prohibited by the attached delegation or superseding law, regulation, or DoW issuance. While the authorities are delegated/responsibilities assigned to the AF/TE, the exercise of the authorities/responsibilities remain subject to the oversight and control of the SecAF, any Assistant Secretary of the Air Force having oversight, the CSAF, and the CSO. Any re-delegation of authority/reassignment of responsibility shall not be effective unless it is in writing, has been reviewed by the General Counsel and/or the Judge Advocate General of the DAF (as appropriate), and is signed by the AF/TE. Any person re-delegating authorities in accordance with this Directive may further restrict or condition the authority being re-delegated. **Attachment 2** depicts the AF/TE organizational structure with subordinate (three-letter) Divisions and associated responsibilities.

5. Continuation of Prior Re-Delegations of Authority/Assignments of Responsibility. Re-delegations of authority/assignments of responsibility made prior to the date of issuance of this directive remain effective insofar as such re-delegations are not inconsistent with the terms of this directive, unless superseded by new issuances.

TROY E. MEINK
Secretary of the Air Force

Attachments:
1. Delegations of Authority/Assignment of Responsibility for AF/TE
2. Organizational Chart/3-Letter Responsibilities
3. Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) between AF/TE and Chief of Safety (AF/SE)

Attachment 1

DELEGATIONS OF SECRETARY OF THE AIR FORCE AUTHORITY /ASSIGNMENTS OF RESPONSIBILITY TO THE DIRECTOR OF TEST AND EVALUATION (AF/TE)

A1.1. Authority relating to the management and operation of specific DoW T&E activities under Department of Defense Directive (DoDD) 3200.11, *Major Range and Test Facility Base (MRTFB)*, as well as Department of Defense Instruction (DoDI) 3200.18, *Management and Operation of the Major Range and Test Facility Base*.

A1.2. Authority relating to the DoW T&E program under DoDI 5010.41, *Joint Test and Evaluation (JT&E) Program*.

A1.3. Authority relating to support of the DoW Test Resource Management Center under DoDD 5105.71, *Department of Defense Test Resource Management Center (TRMC)*.

A1.4. Authority relating to support of the Center for Countermeasures under DoDI 5129.47, *Center for Countermeasures*.

A1.5. Authority relating to the responsibilities, functions, reporting, and coordination with the DOT&E under DoDI 5000.89, *Test and Evaluation*, and DoDI 5000.98, *Operational Test and Evaluation and Live Fire Test and Evaluation*.

A1.6. Authority relating to providing DT&E sufficiency assessments for major defense acquisition programs for which SAF/AQ or SAF/SQ is the milestone decision authority under 10 USC § 4252 and § 4253, and subject to any DoW guidance issued on the same.

A1.7. Authority relating to the responsibilities, functions, reporting, and coordinating with the DOT&E under DoDD 5141.02, *Director of Operational Test and Evaluation (DOT&E)*, as well as with the USD(R&E) under DoDD 5137.02, *Under Secretary of Defense for Research and Engineering (USD(R&E))*. This authority is limited to T&E functional oversight and reporting. Does not supersede the programmatic authorities delegated to SAF/AQ (HAFMD 1-10, *Assistant Secretary of the Air Force (Acquisition)*) or SAF/SQ (HAFMD 1-17, *Assistant Secretary of the Air Force (Space Acquisition and Integration)*).

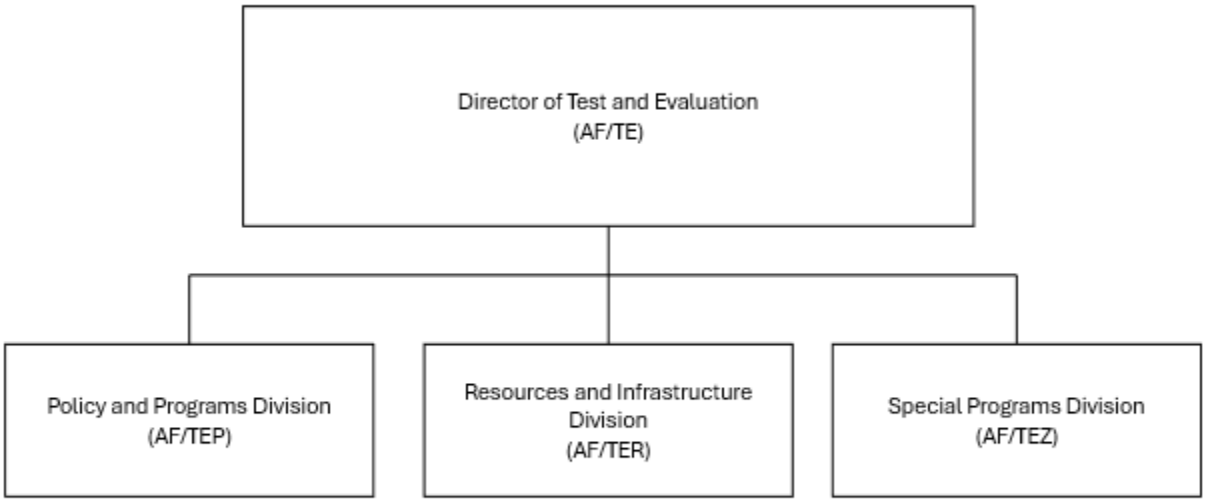
A1.8. Authority relating to the establishment and execution of a Foreign Materiel Program under DoDD S-3325.01, *(U) Foreign Materiel Program (FMP)*, marked as Secret.

A1.9. Authority relating to signing certain end use certificates on FMP items under DoWI 2040.03, *End Use Certificates (EUCs)*. This authority may be delegated no lower than another member of the Senior Executive Service or general officer, unless unavailable to sign, and then signatures may be designated by a military member no lower than O-6 or civilian employee no lower than GS-15. This authority is limited to FMP matters and does not supersede SAF/AQ authorities in HAFMD 1-10.

Attachment 2

DIRECTOR OF TEST AND EVALUATION (AF/TE)

Figure A2.1. Director Of Test and Evaluation (AF/TE).



A2.1. The AF/TE is responsible for the overall supervision of providing professional assistance for all matters pertaining to DAF T&E policy, determining the adequacy of T&E resources required to support weapon system development, and resolving developmental and operational test programmatic issues. AF/TE provides guidance, direction, and oversight for all matters pertaining to the formulation, review, and execution of T&E plans, policies, programs, and budgets. To accomplish DAF T&E missions, AF/TE is organized into three subordinate divisions: The Policy and Programs Division (AF/TEP), Resources and Infrastructure Division (AF/TER), and the Special Programs Division (AF/TEZ). Air Force and Space Force personnel are integrated within these divisions. AF/TE will be supported by a Director, Air Force T&E and a Director, Space Force T&E.

A2.2. Three-letter subordinate office responsibilities include:

A2.2.1. Test and Evaluation Policy and Programs Division (AF/TEP). AF/TEP is responsible for:

A2.2.1.1. Developing DAF T&E guidance and acting as the review authority and office of primary responsibility for T&E policy, DT&E, OT&E, force development evaluation, LFT&E, the JT&E Program, and the Test Pilot School.

A2.2.1.2. Overseeing all DAF T&E activities in support of acquisition. Monitoring congressional legislation and Office of the Secretary of War actions for T&E impacts and acting as the DAF office of primary responsibility and the DAF JT&E Advisory Council member for the OSW-sponsored JT&E Program.

A2.2.1.3. Maintaining a cadre of T&E experts that monitor selected major capability acquisition, middle tier of acquisition, and other programs on the OSD T&E oversight list, and providing regular inputs to senior leadership on these programs to help ensure they are maturing with acceptable test results and quantifiable risks.

A2.2.1.4. Reviewing capability-based requirements documents, T&E strategies, and master plans for proper T&E taskings and responsibilities, and coordinating and notifies AF/TER of any sections requiring DAF test infrastructure and resourcing and appropriate AF/TER review.

A2.2.1.5. Reviewing final test reports and test plans. Attending integrated test team and other T&E working group meetings for selected acquisition programs.

A2.2.1.6. Serving as the T&E policy focal point for all DAF testing conducted by the Air Force Operational Test and Evaluation Center (AFOTEC), the Air Force major commands (MAJCOMs), Space Force field commands (FLDCOMs), direct reporting units, and field operating agencies.

A2.2.1.7. Maintaining close working relationships with OSW (e.g., DOT&E and D(DTE&A)), DAF T&E organizations, other DOW and Service T&E organizations, ensuring DAF T&E equities are addressed and providing expertise on all T&E matters.

A2.2.1.8. Sponsoring T&E briefings to DAF and OSD decision makers on T&E matters relating to the acquisition of DAF systems, and ensuring credible T&E results are provided to decision makers.

A2.2.1.9. Providing T&E expertise to the Air Force Requirements Oversight Council, JROC, the Air Force Review Board, Air Force and Space Force panels, and various acquisition strategy panels supporting the SecAF, CSAF, VCSAF, CSO, VCSO, and the DAF.

A2.2.1.10. Reviewing and coordinating DAF T&E inputs to the OSW/DOT&E Annual Report to Congress.

A2.2.1.11. Providing support to the D(DTE&A), in preparation of DoW Developmental Test and Evaluation annual reporting to Congress.

A2.2.1.12. Supporting formulation of the overall program plan and acquisition strategy with the implementing and operational commands.

A2.2.1.13. Developing AF/TE inputs for DAF planning and programming guidance documents.

A2.2.1.14. Serving as manager of the T&E functional area within the Acquisition Personnel Development Program. Representing the DAF on D(DTE&A) Functional Integrated Product Team for DoW acquisition T&E education, training, and career development standards.

A2.2.1.15. Supporting the DAF-level cross-functional capability development teams to ensure test and training integration needs are captured.

A2.2.1.16. Providing DAF test support, planning, and deconfliction with the test support cells and integrated test forces.

A2.2.2. Resources and Infrastructure Division (AF/TER). AF/TER is responsible for:

A2.2.2.1. Supporting formulation of the plan for T&E resources in conjunction with the implementing and operational commands.

A2.2.2.2. Overseeing the DAF T&E infrastructure and ensuring adequate facilities are available to support DAF T&E activities.

A2.2.2.3. Reviewing all requests to add test capabilities or specific test assets existing on the DAF physical and virtual ranges, but not currently part of the MRTFB, to the TRMC non-MRTFB asset list and weighing all factors to determine what is in the best interest of the DAF.

A2.2.2.4. Performing all Program Element Monitor responsibilities for the following:

A2.2.2.4.1. Air Force T&E infrastructure and program elements: AFOTEC; threat simulator development; Major T&E investment; initial operational test and evaluation; T&E support; facilities restoration and modernization - T&E support; facilities sustainment - T&E support; and Management HQ - T&E support.

A2.2.2.4.2. Space Force T&E infrastructure and program elements: major T&E investment; space test and evaluation.

A2.2.2.5. Acting as the review and signatory authority for test resource planning documentation, Space Force roadmap, and the DAF T&E mission support plan.

A2.2.2.6. Serving as a member of the DAF corporate structure for the strategy, planning, programming, budgeting, and execution (SPPBE) process, which includes principal membership in the Air Force Board, Air Force Council, Space Force Board, and Space Force Council, the investment budget review committee, appropriate integrated process teams, and the Research, Development, Test and Evaluation Panel.

A2.2.2.7. Providing representation to the following working groups: Central Test and Evaluation Investment Program, T&E/Science and Technology (S&T) Program, Joint Mission Environment Test Capability (JMETC), and related subgroups; Threat Simulator Working Group; OSD Test Investment Coordinating Committee; and the DAF T&E Joint Cross-Service Group.

A2.2.2.8. Providing USSF representation to the following working groups: TRMC Program and related subgroups; Developmental Test Working Group; DAF Program Objective Memorandum (POM) corporate processes; Space Strategic Messaging Cells; and the T&E Joint Cross-Service Group.

A2.2.2.9. Serving as the DAF coordinator for the T&E Board of Directors (BoD) and its Executive Secretariat (BoD[ES]).

A2.2.2.9.1. Acting as the DAF headquarters representative for TRMC T&E Strategic Plans.

A2.2.2.9.2. Developing the AF/TE input for congressional inquiries pertaining to DAF MRTFB activities, OTTI activities, and oversight to include staffer days.

A2.2.2.9.3. Reviewing annual TRMC assessment of the DAF infrastructure to the OSD Budget Certification Report.

A2.2.2.10. Reviewing and validating all test war reserve materiel missile and target expenditure requests, and allocating aerial targets for T&E programs, including the Weapon System Evaluation Program.

A2.2.2.11. Programming and reporting missile and target expenditures used in T&E.

A2.2.2.12. Providing strategic oversight and advocacy for resources that enable test programs, capabilities, and facility security and protection of the T&E infrastructure.

A2.2.3. Special Programs Division (AF/TEZ). AF/TEZ is responsible for:

A2.2.3.1. Providing leadership, direction, guidance, and resources to ensure DAF foreign materiel and classified test programs meet documented warfighter requirements.

A2.2.3.2. Providing guidance, management, and oversight of the life cycle process for the FMP and formalizing the staffing of foreign materiel issues in coordination with AF/TE, AF/A2, and SF/S2. Developing all DAF instructions and related manuals on the FMP. Providing management and oversight of the life cycle process for foreign materiel acquisition and exploitation of foreign weapon systems, dual-use systems, software and components. Acting as the lead DAF point of contact for foreign materiel-related activities.

A2.2.3.3. Collecting and consolidating DAF foreign materiel requirements from major DAF customers. This includes, but is not limited to, Air Combat Command (representing Pacific Air Forces and United States Air Forces in Europe-Air Forces Africa), Air Mobility Command, Air Force Special Operations Command, Air Force Materiel Command, Air Force Test Center, Air Force Research Laboratory, Air Force Global Strike Command, Air Education and Training Command, National Air and Space Intelligence Center, Combat Forces Command, Space Systems Command, Space Training and Readiness Command, Space Development Agency, AFOTEC, Air Force Rapid Capabilities Office, and Space Rapid Capabilities Office.

A2.2.3.4. Supporting all SPPBE activities for the foreign materiel life cycle process within AF/TE. Supporting AF/A2, SF/S2, Air Staff, Space Staff, and others in SPPBE activities related to Foreign Materiel Acquisition and Exploitation funded through the General Defense Intelligence Program.

A2.2.3.5. Directing FMP execution to satisfy the needs of operations, acquisition, T&E, and scientific and technical intelligence communities in support of warfighter requirements.

A2.2.3.6. Providing guidance and oversight of DAF organizations executing foreign materiel programs and classified testing.

A2.2.3.7. Providing guidance and oversight of the DAF FME office, in coordination with AF/A2 and SF/S2.

A2.2.3.8. Staffing all foreign materiel acquisition procured through commercial channels. Supporting AF/A2 and SF/S2 office oversight on government-to-government initiatives and efforts using intelligence methods and sources.

A2.2.3.9. Recommending to AF/TE to convene the DAF FMP Board in response to critical FMP issues.

A2.2.3.10. Representing the DAF in multi-service, multi-component, and multi-national foreign materiel agreements. Approving all disclosures and invitations by DoW components that obligate the DAF to support multi-service, multi-component, and multi-national foreign materiel requirements.

A2.2.3.11. Advising AF/A2 and SF/S2 office on initial multinational intelligence agreements related to foreign materiel. Providing input to AF/A2 and S2 office prior to approval of disclosures and invitations by DoW components that obligate the DAF to support multinational foreign materiel intelligence requirements.

A2.2.3.12. Representing DAF on the DoW FMP Board of Directors.

A2.2.3.13. Responding to congressional inquiries on non-General Defense Intelligence Program-related issues regarding FMP funding and execution.

A2.2.3.14. Performing SPPBE and program element monitor functions for Air Force Materiel Command, and AFOTEC infrastructure programs supporting classified advanced system test activities. Ensuring adequate resources are available to support test requirements generated by the USAF MAJCOMs, USSF FLDCOMDs, research and development activities, and intelligence agencies.

A2.2.3.15. Representing AF/TE on the Special Programs Review Group overseeing all DAF Special Access Programs.

Attachment 3

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE (SOP) BETWEEN AF/TE AND CHIEF OF SAFETY (AF/SE)

Figure A3.1. Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Between AF/TE and Chief of Safety (AF/SE).

A3.1. Applicability. This SOP applies to AF/TE and AF/SE (HAFMD 1-46, *Chief of Safety*) personnel responsible for policy, program management, and guidance related to safety within the Major Range and Test Facility Base (MRTFB). This SOP is to reduce duplication of staff actions and enhance efficiency.

A3.2. Authority and Responsibility

A3.2.1. AF/TE retains authority and responsibility for management and operation of the MRTFB as delegated through public law, executive order or Department of Defense Directive and Instruction including DoDI 3200.18.

A3.2.2. AF/SE retains authority and responsibility for safety and nuclear surety as delegated through public law, executive order or Department of Defense Directive and Instruction including DoDD 4715.1E, *Environment, Safety, and Occupational Health (ESOH)*.

A3.3. Coordination of Policies

A3.3.1. AF/TE submits MRTFB policies impacting safety to AF/SE for concurrence before publication.

A3.3.2. AF/SE submits safety policies impacting MRTFB to AF/TE for concurrence before publication.

A3.4. Review and Concurrence

A3.4.1. AF/TE review and concurrence are required prior to implementing any policy, plan, and program which involves the management or operation of the MRTFB.

A3.4.2. AF/SE concurrence is required for policies involving nuclear surety, flight, occupational, explosive, directed energy, or space safety within MRTFB.

A3.5. Revisions. These operating procedures may be reviewed and revised as deemed necessary by the Secretary of the Air Force. AF/SE or AF/TE may also initiate a revision. OPRs must follow revision procedures as mandated in Headquarters Operating Instruction (HOI) 90-1, *Headquarters Air Force Mission Directives and Department of Defense Issuances Program*.

OTIS C. JONES, Brig Gen, USAF Chief of Safety	CHRISTOPHER M. WILCOX, SES, DAF Director of Test and Evaluation